

Phishing Awareness Training

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship — Task 2

1. Introduction

Phishing is one of the most common cybersecurity threats where attackers use fake messages, emails, or websites to trick users into revealing sensitive information.

This project focuses on creating awareness about phishing attacks, identifying suspicious activities, understanding social engineering techniques, and learning best practices to stay protected.

2. Objective

The objectives of this project are:

- To understand phishing attacks and their impact.
- To learn how to identify phishing emails and fake websites.
- To understand social engineering techniques used by attackers.
- To educate users about safe online practices.
- To improve cybersecurity awareness through interactive learning.

3. Types of Phishing Attacks

Email Phishing

Attackers send fake emails pretending to be trusted organizations to steal user information.

Spear Phishing

A targeted phishing attack designed for a specific person or organization.

Smishing

Phishing attacks performed through SMS or text messages.

Vishing

Phishing attempts carried out through phone calls.

4. Recognizing Phishing Emails

Users can identify phishing emails by checking:

- Unknown or suspicious sender addresses.
- Urgent messages creating fear or pressure.

- Suspicious links and attachments.
- Grammar and spelling mistakes.
- Requests for passwords or personal information.
- Offers that appear too good to be true.

5. Identifying Fake Websites

Fake websites can be detected by:

- Checking the website URL carefully.
- Looking for HTTPS security.
- Checking domain spelling.
- Avoiding websites received from unknown sources.
- Verifying the website before entering sensitive information.

Example:

Real website:

[example.com](#)

Suspicious website:

[example-security-login.com](#)

6. Social Engineering Techniques

Attackers use psychological methods to manipulate users. Common techniques include:

Fear

Creating panic by claiming an account will be blocked.

Urgency

Forcing users to take quick actions without verification.

Trust

Pretending to be a bank, company, or trusted person.

Curiosity

Using attractive messages or fake offers to get attention.

7. Real-World Example

A common phishing attack involves fake banking emails. Attackers send messages that look like they are from a bank and ask users to verify their account details through a fake website.

If users enter their information, attackers can misuse the stolen credentials.

8. Prevention and Best Practices

Users can protect themselves by following these practices:

- Do not click unknown links.
- Verify the sender before responding.
- Never share passwords through email or messages.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Use strong and unique passwords.
- Keep software and antivirus updated.
- Report suspicious emails.

9. Interactive Quiz

Question 1:

You receive an email asking for your password verification. What should you do?

- A) Provide your password
- B) Report and delete the email
- C) Click the provided link

Correct Answer: B

Question 2:

A website has a suspicious domain name. What should you do?

- A) Enter your information
- B) Ignore security warnings
- C) Verify the website before using it

Correct Answer: C

10. Conclusion

Phishing attacks mainly target human mistakes rather than technical weaknesses. Awareness and careful online behavior are important defenses against phishing.

This project successfully explains phishing attacks, social engineering methods, identification techniques, and prevention strategies to improve cybersecurity awareness.

Author

Nida Kanwal

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship